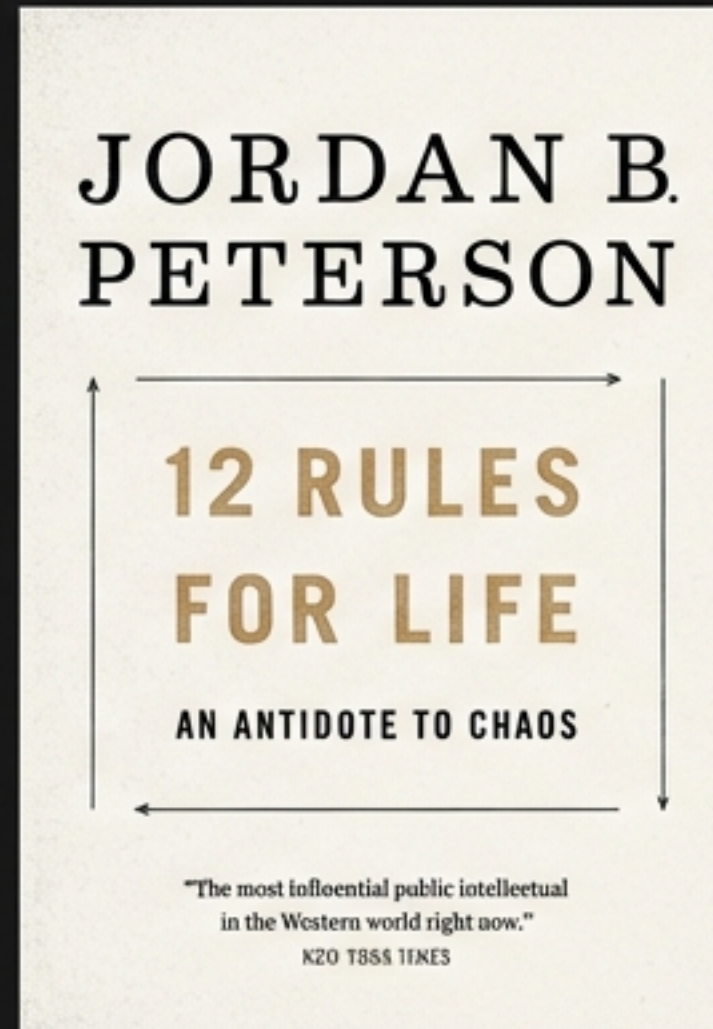




12 RULES FOR LIFE

An Antidote to Chaos

Based on the work of Dr. Jordan B. Peterson

"We crave freedom, but without rules, we become slaves to our passions."

ORDER (Yang)

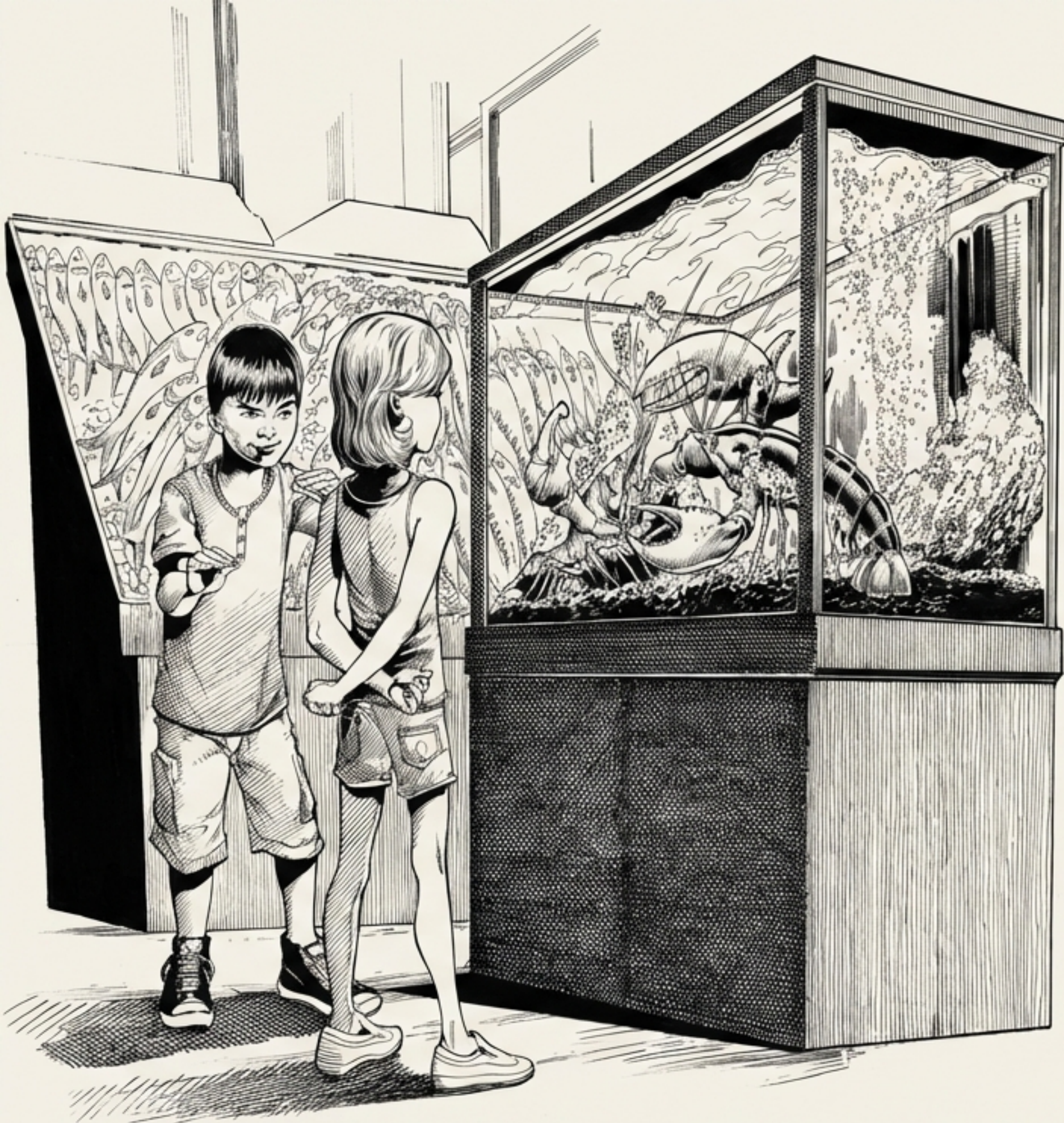
-  - Explored Territory
-  - Structure & Predictability
-  - The Shire / The Father
-  - Where behavior matches expectation



CHAOS (Yin)

-  - Unexplored Territory
-  - Possibility & The Unknown
-  - The Underworld / The Mother
-  - What emerges when things fall apart

**Meaning is not found in the safety of Order, nor in the total freedom of Chaos.
Meaning is found on the border between the two—one foot in what you know,
one foot in what you are mastering.**



RULE 1: Stand up straight with your shoulders back

The Biological Basis of Hierarchy

The dominance hierarchy is not a modern capitalist invention or a patriarchal construct. It is a biological constant older than trees.

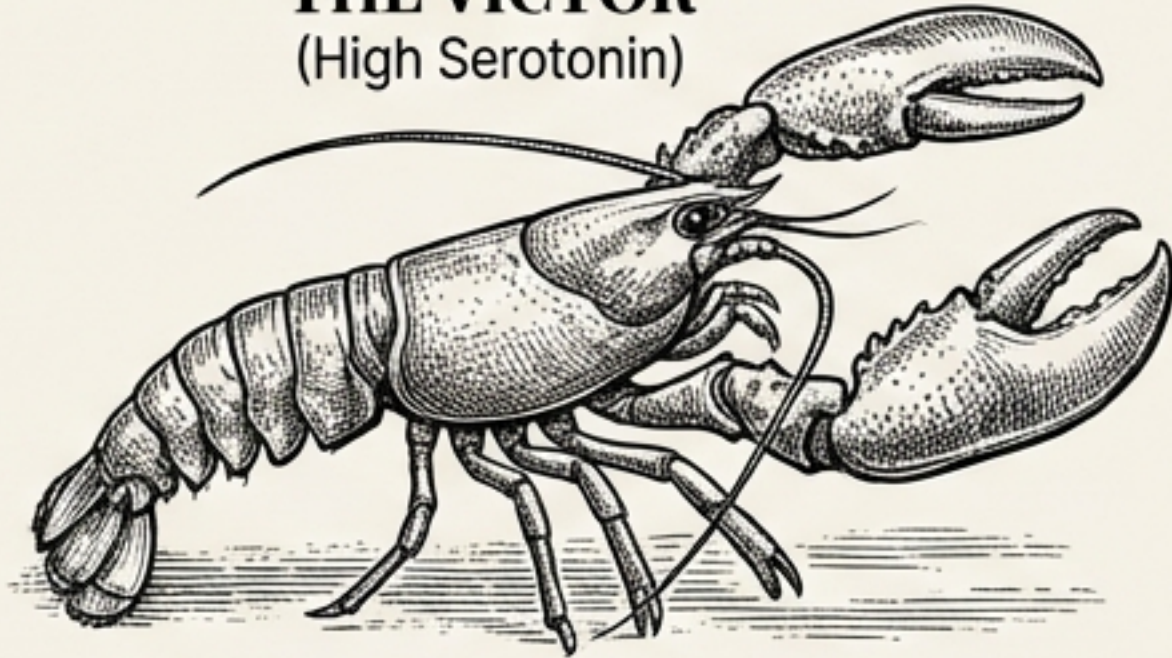
Subject: The Lobster

- ☞ - Diverged from humans 350 million years ago.
- ☞ - Shares the same basic neurochemistry governing status.
- ☞ - The brain tracks position on a scale of 1 to 10.

“Hierarchy is a feature of nature, not a bug of culture.”

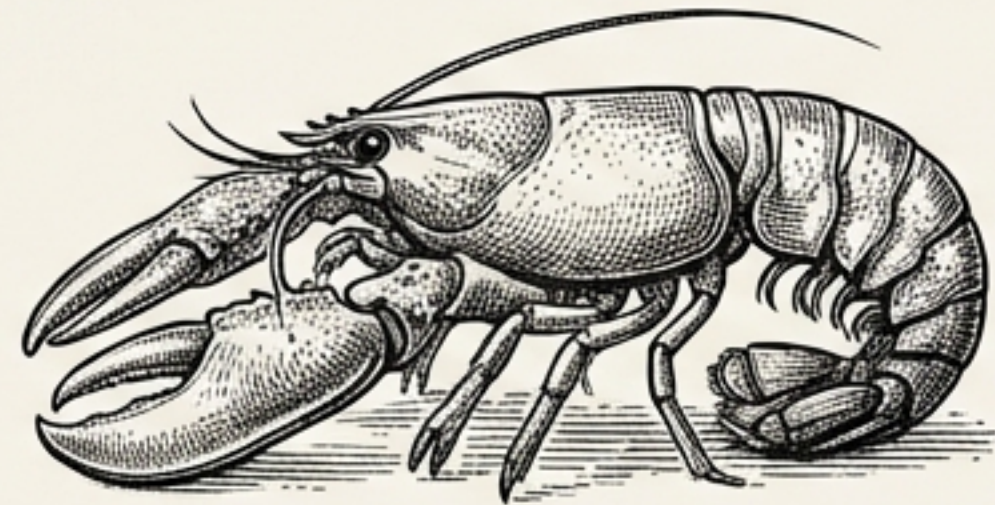
The Neurochemistry of Defeat and Victory

THE VICTOR
(High Serotonin)

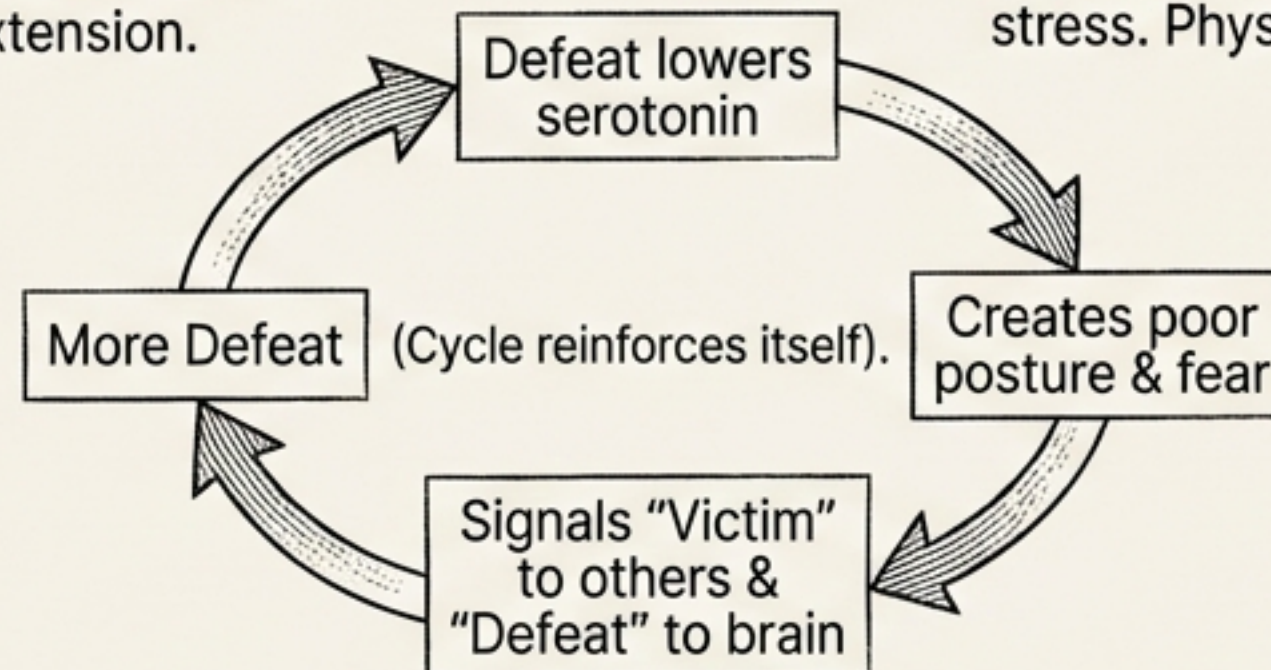


High Serotonin / Low Octopamine.
Chemically regulated boldness.
Postural extension.

THE DEFEATED
(Low Serotonin)

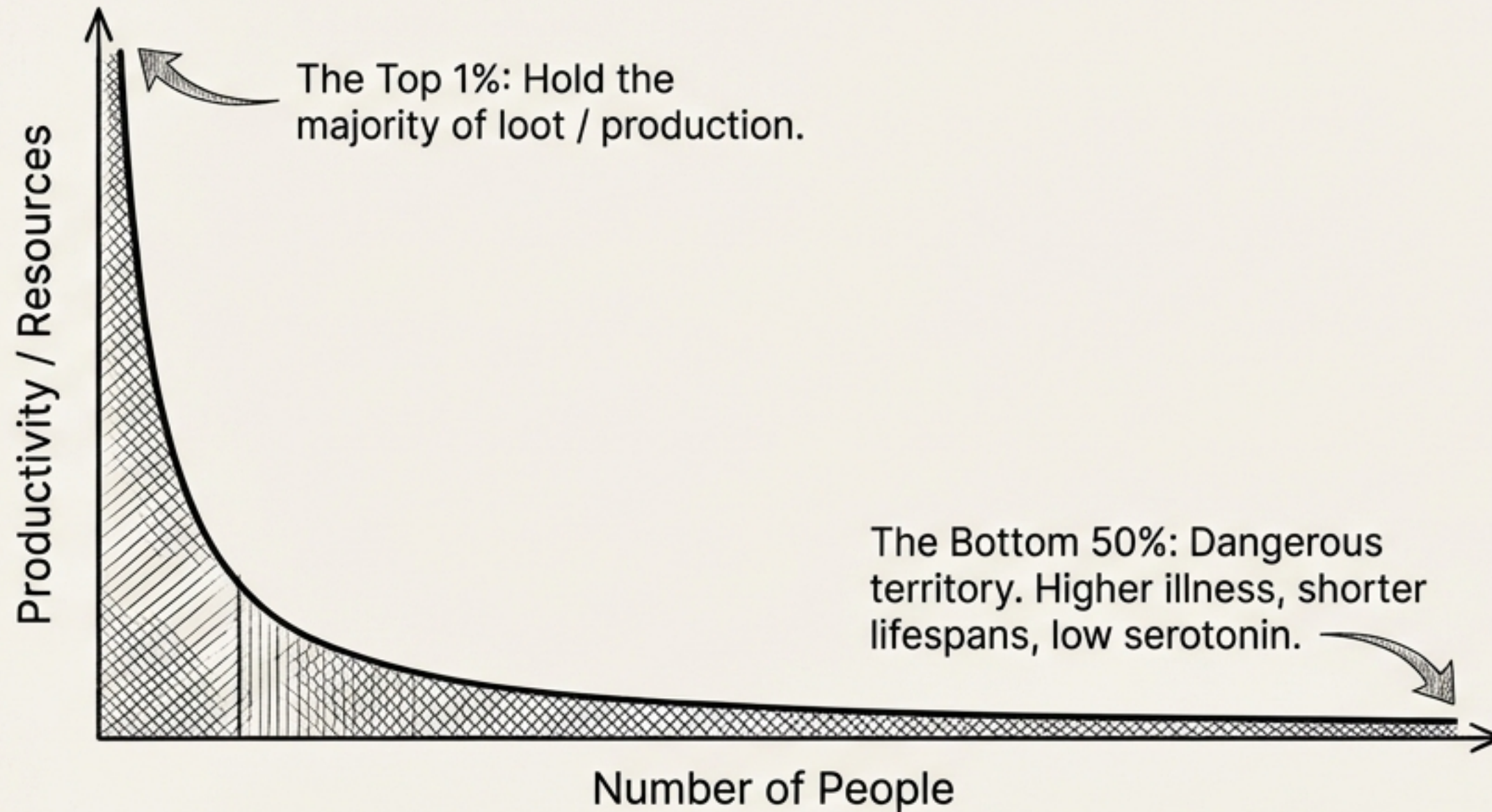


Low Serotonin / High Octopamine.
Inhibition and fear. Hyper-reactive to
stress. Physically shrinking.



Key Fact:
Antidepressants
(SSRIs) have the
same effect on
lobsters as
humans—cheering
them up and
making them fight
harder.

The Principle of Unequal Distribution



Price's Law & The Pareto Distribution

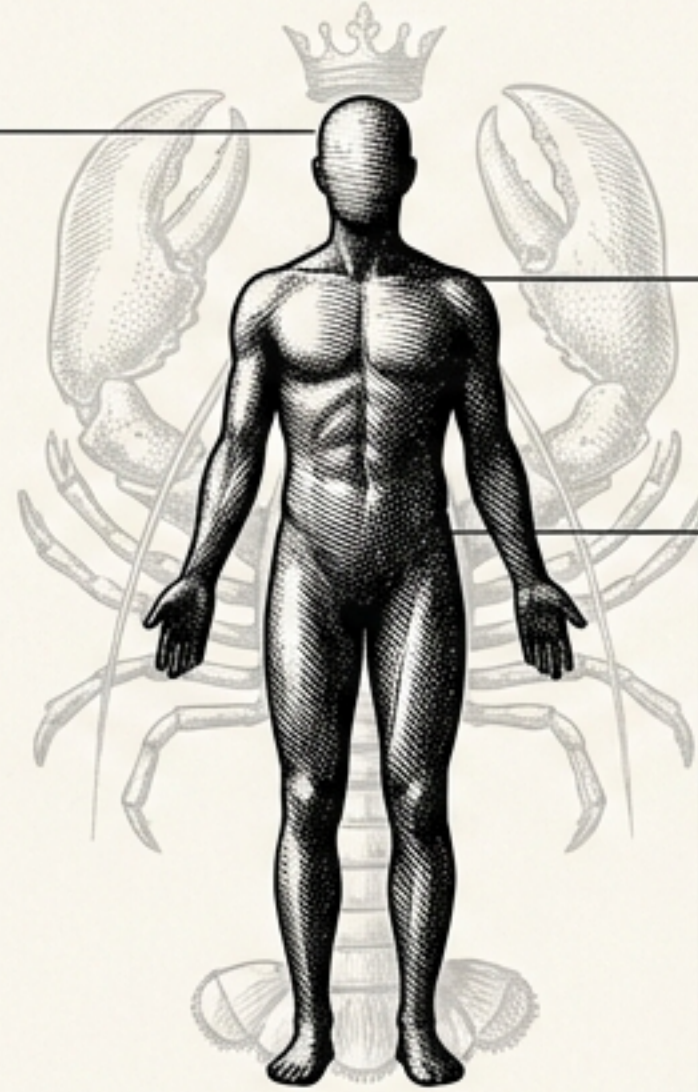
- In creative domains, the **square root of the number of employees does 50% of the work.**
- A tiny fraction of authors sell all the books.
- Four classical composers wrote almost all the music played by orchestras.

The Matthew Principle: “To those who have everything, more will be given; from those who have nothing, everything will be taken.”

The Psycho-Spiritual Act

Accept the Burden of Being

Voluntarily facing the tragedy of life with eyes wide open.



Step into the Hierarchy

Dare to be dangerous. Speak your mind. Put your desires forward.

Build the Ark

Protect the world from the flood of chaos through competence and courage.

Look for your inspiration to the victorious lobster, with its 350 million years of practical wisdom.



RULE 2: Treat yourself like someone you are responsible for helping

The Medication Paradox

Fact: There is a 33% non-compliance rate for filling prescriptions.

Fact: Even organ transplant patients often fail to take their life-saving anti-rejection drugs.

The Twist: People fill prescriptions for their pets much more reliably than for themselves.

Why would you buy medication for your dog, and administer it carefully, but not do the same for yourself?

The Domain of What Matters



The Genesis Narrative

- Adam & Eve eat the fruit → Eyes are opened.
- The Realization: We are naked.

The Psychological Interpretation

- **Nakedness = Vulnerability.** We know we can be hurt.
- **Knowledge of Good & Evil =** We know *how* to hurt others.
- **Result: Self-Loathing.** Unlike the innocent predator (the dog), we are aware of our own capacity for malevolence. We feel unworthy of care.

A Spark of the Divine

The Shift: Despite our flaws, we have a capacity for consciousness that can create Order from Chaos.

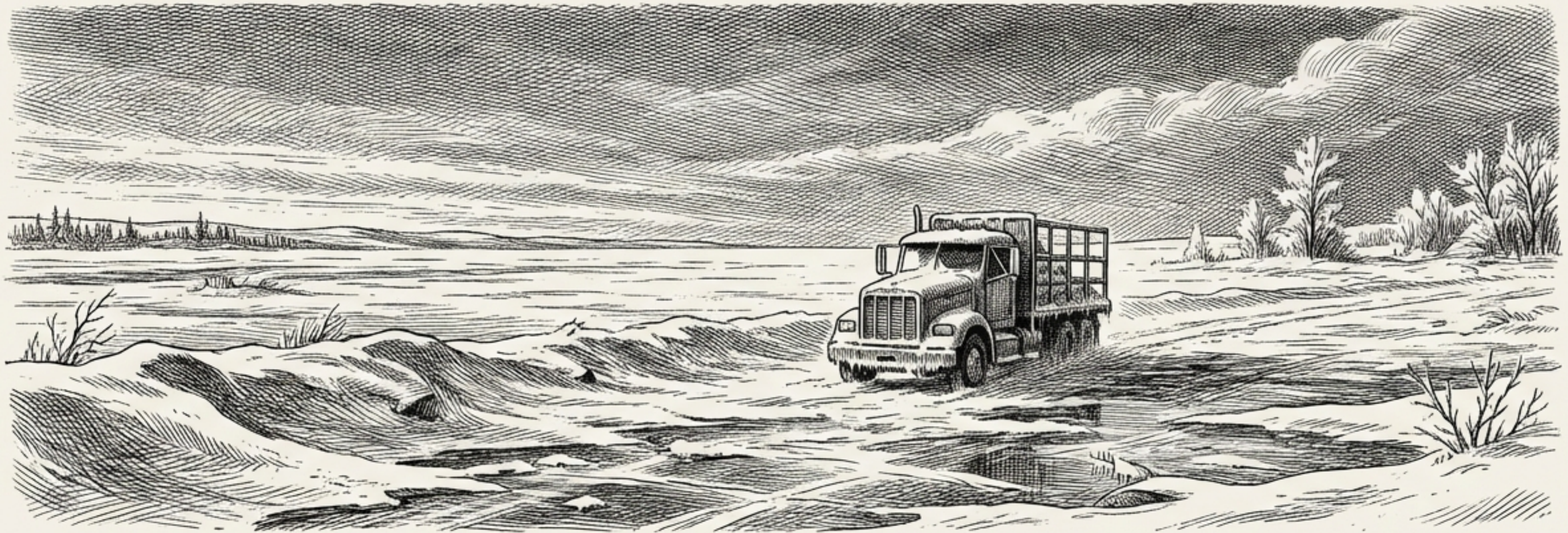
Redefining “Help”:

- Treating yourself well does not mean “making yourself happy”.
- It means parenting yourself. You don't give a child candy to make them happy; you make them brush their teeth because it is **good** for them.

The Obligation:

You must determine what your life would look like if you were caring for yourself properly. You are not your own possession to torture.

RULE 3: Make friends with people who want the best for you



The Setting: Fairview, Alberta. 40 below zero. A frozen frontier.

The Characters:

- Chris: Brilliant but resentful. His truck was the "exoskeleton of a nihilist".
- Ed: Smart but drifting. Trapped in a semi-conscious existence.

The Trap: The Repetition Compulsion. We often choose friends who reinforce our own cynicism and failure because it is familiar.

Rescuing the Damned

The False Virtue:

We often associate with failing people not to help them, but because it is easier. It validates our own cynicism.

Literary Case Study: Dostoevsky's *Notes from Underground*

- The protagonist invites Liza to his home not to save her, but to humiliate her to boost his fragile ego.



The Hard Truth:

Down is a lot easier than up. If you put a delinquent teen among civilized peers, the delinquency spreads; the stability does not.

A Reciprocal Arrangement

The Litmus Test:

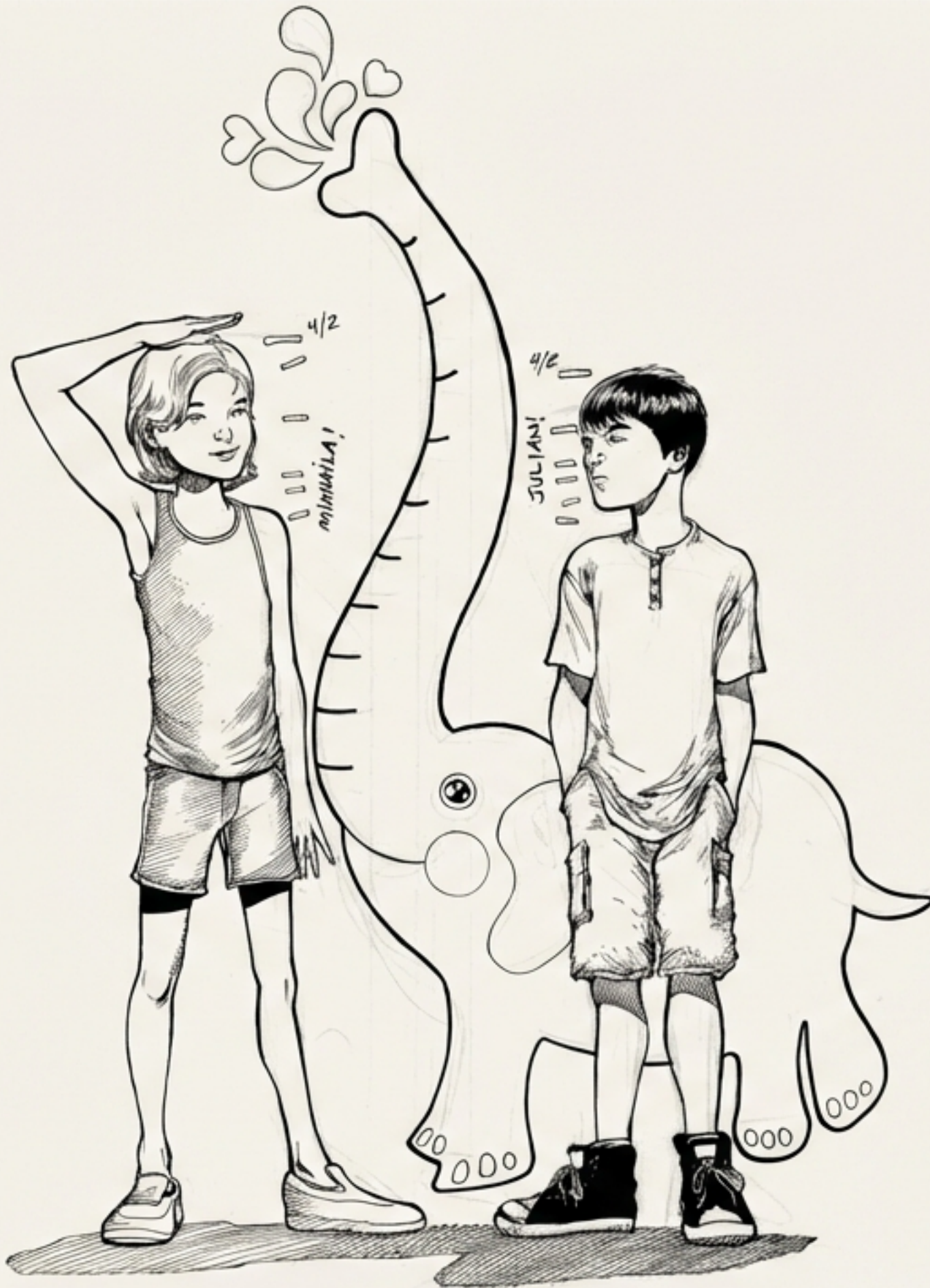
If you wouldn't recommend a friendship to your sister, father, or son, why do you accept it for yourself?



The Mandate:

1. You are not morally obligated to support someone who is making the world worse.
2. True friends will not tolerate your cynicism. They will punish you carefully when you fail and encourage you when you succeed.

**Every good example is a fateful challenge,
and every hero, a judge.**



RULE 4: Compare yourself to who you were yesterday, not to who someone else is today

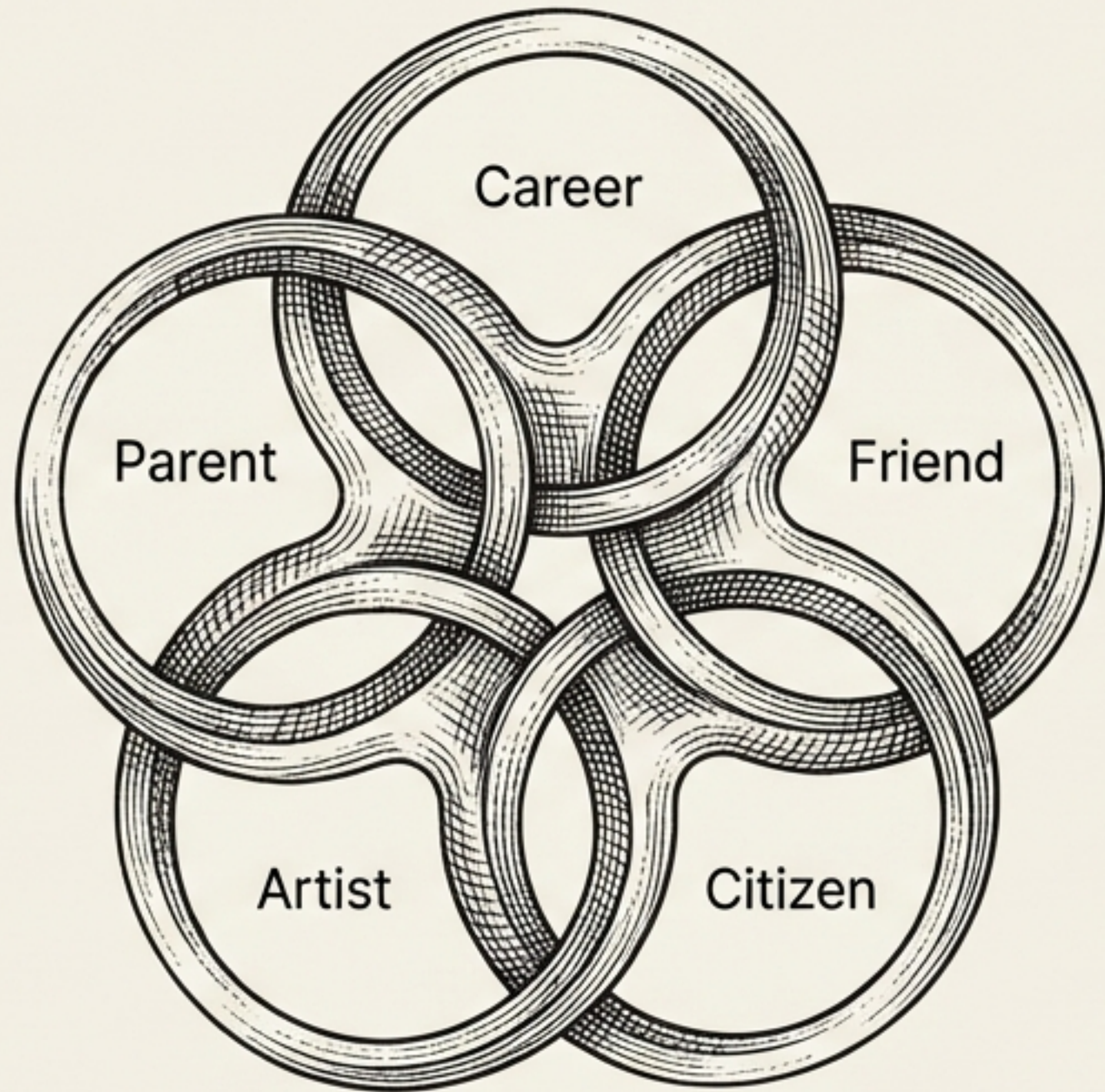
The Internal Critic

The Modern Problem: Vertical Hierarchies.

- In the past, you only had to be the best in your village.
- Today, you are competing with 7 billion people online.

The Consequence: The Internal Critic concludes that 'Worthlessness is the default condition' because there is always someone richer, younger, or more talented.

Many Good Games



Life is not a single game. It is a complex set of games.

- If you are losing one game, try another.
- If you can't find a game, invent a new one.

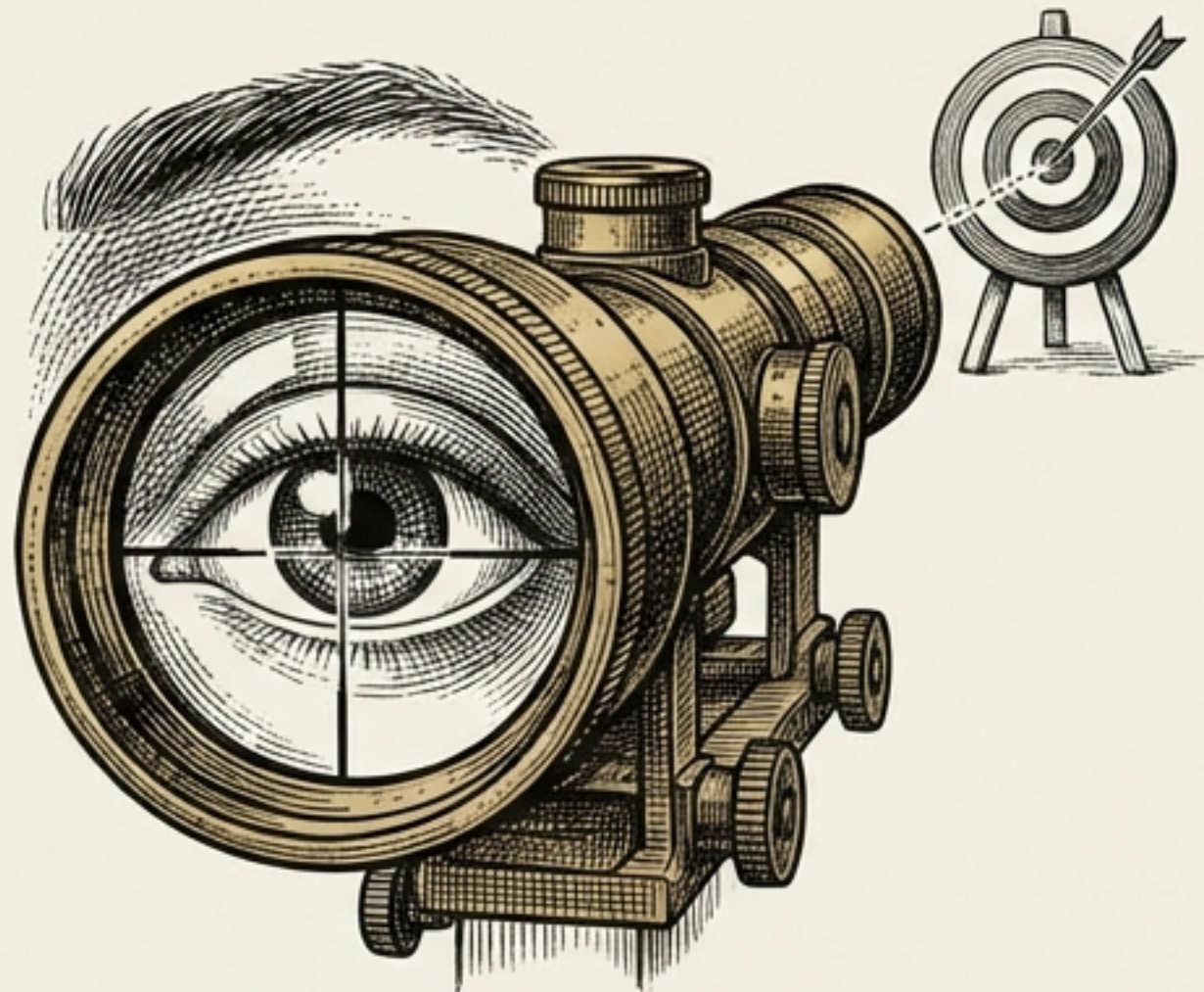
The Optical Illusion

When you envy others, you are comparing your 'behind-the-scenes' footage with their 'highlight reel'. You do not see their specific tragedies.

The Point of Our Eyes

The Mechanism:
We cannot navigate without an aim.

- 'Sin' (hamartia) originally meant 'to miss the mark'.
- We are always at **Point A (Insufficiency)** moving toward **Point B (Better)**.



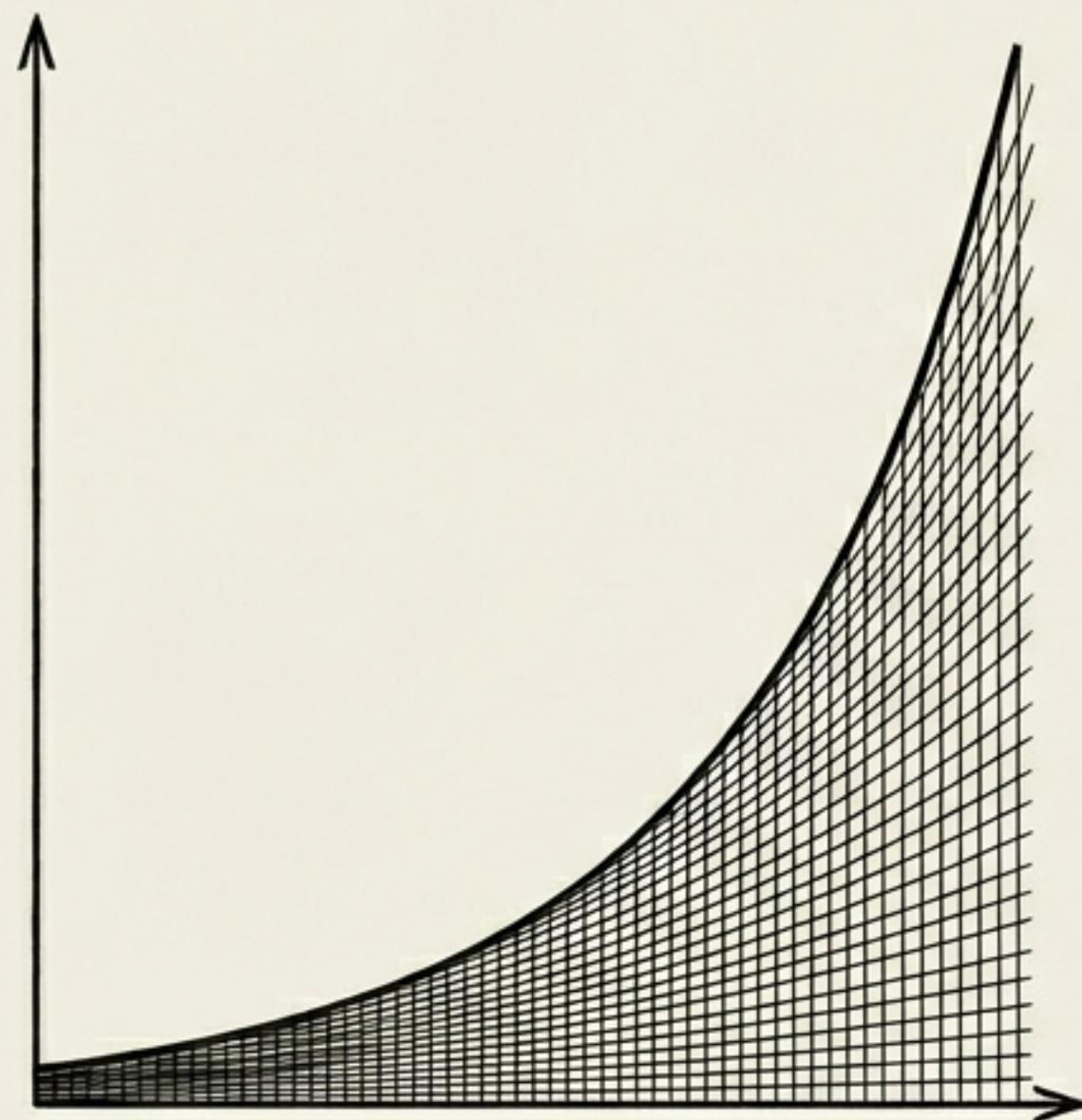
The Strategy:
The Inspector.

- Walk through your psychological house like a home inspector.
- You cannot fix something if you don't admit it is broken.

Negotiate, Don't Tyrannize

**The Dialogue:
Treat yourself like
a bad employee
but a worse boss.**

- Don't kick the dog. Say:
"If you do the dishes, we
can have a double-shot
espresso."



Compound Interest

Aim Small:

- **Goal:** By the end of the day, I want things to be a tiny bit better than they were this morning.

- **Result:** Small improvements repeated daily lead to an entirely different life in three years.

The Pillars of Order

**RULE 1:
Stand Up
Straight**

Accept the
biological
burden of
Being.

**RULE 2:
Treat Yourself
Responsibly**

Care for your
spark of the
divine.

**RULE 3:
Choose
Friends
Wisely**

Surround
yourself with
those who
aim upward.

**RULE 4:
Compare to
Yesterday**

Focus on your
own
incremental
trajectory.

*‘He whose life has a why
can bear almost any how.’
— Friedrich Nietzsche*

Cast dead, rigid order back into the chaos...
and establish a better, more meaningful order.



Penguin
Random House
RANDOM HOUSE CANADA